

HÜSEYİN YURTSEVEN

Senior Engineering Leader | Machine Learning & Personalization

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Accomplished engineering executive with 20+ years of software development experience and 10+ years leading high-performance teams at scale. Proven cross-functional leader across engineering and science functions — building and scaling organizations of Applied Scientists, Machine Learning Engineers, and Data Scientists that deliver measurable business impact. Track record of success across startups and large-scale enterprises (Amazon, Alibaba Group, Delivery Hero), building cross-functional organizations with clear independent value streams, strategic domain-driven design approaches, and empowered team topologies that optimize for autonomy, ownership, and fast flow of delivery.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Amazon / Amazon Music

Senior Software Development Manager, Amazon Music Machine Learning & Managing Director, Snackable OÜ (Estonia) *January 2023 - Present | Berlin, Germany*

Lead 4 globally distributed cross-functional teams of 40+ Applied Scientists, Machine Learning Engineers, and Software Development Engineers within Amazon Music Personalization organization across Berlin, Tallinn, and the US (LA/SFO).

- Direct leadership of 4 teams: Customer Intelligence (Tallinn), Content Expertise (Berlin), Candidate Intelligence (Berlin), and Personalized Playlists (US)
 - Own the Domain Intelligence platform — the core personalization-as-a-service layer powering customer understanding, content expertise, and intelligent candidate retrieval
 - Drive strategic technical initiatives in personalization algorithms, ranking systems, and customer behavior modeling
 - Architect scalable ML systems serving millions of Amazon Music customers globally
 - Collaborate with product, science, and engineering leadership on roadmap and technical strategy
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Trendyol / Alibaba Group

Head of Engineering & Managing Director, Germany Office *December 2021 - January 2023 | Istanbul, Turkey & Berlin, Germany*

Led engineering organization for local commerce vertical, managing 17+ teams across logistics, assortment, and store operations. Concurrently served as Managing Director of Trendyol's Germany office, overseeing local operations and market expansion.

- Established organizational structure and team topologies optimizing for autonomy and delivery velocity
- Served on tribe leadership group, shaping company-wide technical strategy
- Led Trendyol's Germany office as Managing Director, driving market presence and operational setup
- Partnered with data engineering and data science teams to build data-driven capabilities
- Introduced OKR framework, Executive Action Team, and RFC/ADR processes
- Transformed organization to outcome-driven, empowered team model

Technologies: Python, FastAPI, Golang, React, scikit-learn, TensorFlow, PyTorch, Microservices, MongoDB, PostgreSQL, Elasticsearch, AWS, GCP

Delivery Hero SE

Director, Software Engineering *July 2020 - December 2021 | Berlin, Germany*

Led Q-Commerce engineering tribe, managing managers of managers, senior data science managers, and engineering teams.

- Directed engineering organization including platform teams, data science teams, and product engineering
- Launched comprehensive Product Information Management (PIM) system
- Redesigned team structure resulting in measurable improvements in delivery velocity and quality
- Implemented OKR methodology across tribe, aligning engineering efforts with business outcomes
- Developed multi-criteria ranking solution improving search relevance

Technologies: Python, FastAPI, Golang, React, TensorFlow, PyTorch, Microservices, PostgreSQL, Elasticsearch, AWS, GCP

Kariyer.net

Chief Technology Officer *February 2020 - July 2020 | Istanbul, Turkey*

Led technology organization of Turkey's premier job board and ATS platforms, managing 80+ engineers, data scientists, DevOps engineers, and QA professionals.

- Directed all engineering, R&D, DevOps, and QA functions across multiple product lines
- Established software architecture standards and scalability principles for high-traffic platforms
- Implemented OKR and Agile methodologies across engineering organization

Technologies: .NET Core, Python, React, Next.js, Vue.js, scikit-learn, TensorFlow, Microservices, Azure

BluTV

Chief Technology Officer *April 2018 - February 2020 | Istanbul, Turkey*

Led technology vision for Turkey's leading OTT streaming platform, managing 40+ engineers, data scientists, and DevOps professionals.

- Directed end-to-end technology development for OTT platform serving millions of users
- Built in-house capabilities across video delivery, DRM, recommendation systems, and content management
- Developed proprietary streaming infrastructure supporting HLS, MPEG-DASH, and multi-DRM
- Built ML-powered recommendation and personalization systems

Technologies: Python, React, scikit-learn, Microservices, MongoDB, PostgreSQL, HLS, MPEG-DASH, DRM, AWS

Dogan TV

Director of Software Development and Technical Innovation *September 2015 - April 2018 | Istanbul, Turkey*

Led 70+ person engineering organization across multiple media properties and platforms.

- Directed development of headless CMS (Blupoint CMS), eCRM, DRM systems, and custom CDN solutions
- Architected Hadoop-based ML systems for recommendation, churn prediction, and segmentation
- Processed and analyzed clickstream and video event data from 40+ platforms

Platform Portfolio: blutv.com.tr, netd.com, kanald.com.tr, cnnturk.com, dsmart.com.tr

Technologies: Python, Vue.js, scikit-learn, Microservices, MongoDB, Elasticsearch, Hadoop, DRM technologies

Previous roles at Dogan TV: - Software Development and Technical Innovation Manager (2014 - 2015) - netd.com — Software Development Manager (2012 - 2014) - cnnturk.com — Software Development Manager (2009 - 2012) - cnnturk.com — Senior Software Developer (2008 - 2009)

PUBLICATIONS

A Unified Recommendation Model for Features Summarization Amazon Science | <https://www.amazon.science/publications/a-unified-recommendation-model-for-features-summarization>

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Leadership: Cross-Functional Team Leadership, Organizational Design, Strategic Planning, OKR Implementation, Agile Methodologies

AI/ML: Machine Learning, Recommendation Systems, Personalization, Ranking Algorithms, Deep Learning, MLOps

Engineering: Distributed Systems, Microservices, Python, Golang, Java, JavaScript/TypeScript, React, Cloud (AWS, GCP, Azure)

Data: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Elasticsearch, Redis, Data Pipeline Architecture

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Physics | Istanbul University | 2000 - 2005

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- AWS Solution Architect (2018)
 - Deep Learning (2018)
 - Kubernetes (2017)
 - Machine Learning (2013)
 - Project Management and PMP Preparation (2012)
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ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Languages: Turkish (Native), English (Fluent) **Location:** Berlin, Germany **Work Authorization:** Permanent Residency

More about my leadership philosophy: <https://hyurtseven81.github.io/>